

Synopsis of the National Youth Strategy (England)

Youth Matters: Your National Youth Strategy is the UK Government's first national youth strategy for England in over 20 years. Launched in December 2025, it sets out a 10-year plan to improve the lives of young people aged 10–21 (up to 25 for those with special educational needs and disabilities). The strategy was developed with input from more than 14,000 young people and aims to ensure that every young person can thrive.

Vision

The strategy's central vision is that every young person should have:

- A safe place to go
- Someone they trust and can rely on
- A community they feel part of

Four Key Outcomes

The strategy focuses on improving outcomes in four areas:

1. Safety – helping young people feel safe both online and offline.
2. Connection and Empowerment – strengthening relationships, belonging, and participation in communities.
3. Opportunities – improving access to education, skills, employment, and enrichment activities.
4. Health and Wellbeing – supporting better physical and mental health.

Three Major Shifts in Delivery

The government proposes changing how youth services are delivered by:

- Moving decision-making and funding closer to local communities.
- Creating better coordination between services such as youth work, health, education, and employment support.
- Ensuring young people are actively involved in decisions that affect them.

Ten Action Areas

The strategy is organised around ten action areas:

1. Trusted adults
2. Strengthening the youth workforce
3. Friends and relationships
4. Richer lives and enrichment opportunities
5. Good work and employment
6. Keeping young people safe
7. Places to go and youth facilities
8. Health and wellbeing
9. Delivering services with young people
10. Accountability and measuring progress

Key Commitments

Among the headline commitments are:

- Expanding access to trusted adults and mentors.
- Building or refurbishing up to 250 youth facilities.
- Supporting around 2,500 youth organisations through a Better Youth Spaces programme.
- Establishing 50 Young Futures Hubs that bring together youth, health, employment, and other support services.
- Strengthening the youth work profession and workforce.

Significance

The strategy recognises challenges facing young people, including the impacts of the pandemic, rising living costs, mental health pressures, social isolation, and concerns about future opportunities. It seeks to rebuild youth services, increase youth participation in decision-making, and create a more coordinated system of support over the next decade.

Summary

The National Youth Strategy is a 10-year, youth-led plan to improve safety, wellbeing, opportunities, and community connection for young people in England through stronger local services, investment in youth provision, and greater youth participation in decision-making.

Read the full strategy here: [Youth Matters: Your National Youth Strategy - GOV.UK](#)